

Graphics Cards

High-end

Gainward GeForce 6800 GT 256MB Golden Sample

Specs: 16 Pixel Pipelines, Shader Model 3.0 support, Core Clock - 350MHz, Memory Clock - 500MHz, Fill Rate - 5600 million texels per second, Memory Bandwidth - 32GB/s.

Our Verdict: The latest Golden Sample monster from Gainward is only second to the 6800 Ultra. In our tests, nothing could match it in terms of performance. Any game that we threw at it was mercilessly

slaughtered. The mammoth heat sink with dual fans only gives this card an alien look-and-feel. Make sure you have enough power to feed this card with or else you will suffer from a dead power supply malaise. If you want to own any game right now, this card is the silver bullet you have been waiting for. Bite it!

Runner-up:
Powercolour X800



Hard Drives

120 GB Hard Drives

Maxtor DiamondMax Plus 9 120 GB

Specs: 120 GB, SATA 150, 7200 RPM, Data Buffer 8MB

Our Verdict: The DiamondMax Plus 9 120 GB tops our chart for 120 GB disk capacity internal hard drives. The 120 GB DiamondMax Plus 9 returns an impressive drive index score of 39,405 in Si Soft Sandra. Sequential writing and reading speeds are impressive and the drive logged 59/57 MB per second

respectively on these parameters. The drive took around 51 seconds to copy 1 GB data from one partition to the other, which is reasonably okay.

Runner-up:
Samsung Sp1213C



Input devices

Desktop Combo

Microsoft Wireless Optical Desktop Comfort Edition

Specs: Wireless Keyboard and mouse, PS/2 and USB compatible, Zoom function and Ergonomic Keyboard Design.

Our Verdict: The new line of input devices from Microsoft marries two important aspects—ergonomics and convenience. The Wireless Optical Desktop Comfort Edition consists of an ergonomically designed wireless keyboard and an optical wireless mouse. The ergonomic keyboard takes a new approach in design—the keys are placed on a

curved slanting ridge and are comfortable to use. One feature that sets this keyboard apart is the presence of a zoom slider that allows zooming of supported documents. The ambidextrous optical mouse has a tilt function that is handy if you use applications such as Excel. It requires two AA batteries, but can run on one as well. Overall, this desktop combo offers the best you can expect of an input device for general usage.

Runner-up:
Logitech LX-700



Flashback To December 2000

IBM Deskstar 72GXP DTLA-307075

Specs: : 80 GB, ATA 66, 7200 RPM, Data buffer of 2MB.

Evolution: Almost every PC component that has evolved over the last four years has seen tremendous boost in performance. But, despite development in technologies powering a hard drive the real-world boost in performance is not as expected after four years. Although current drives are more robust and reliable, they remain the slowest performing component in your desktop. Prices have also dropped substantially and a 250 GB drive is now within reach for most.

Microsoft Intellimouse Eye And Acer Airkey

Evolution: There was a time when input devices were neglected by manufacturers and users. Over time, emphasis is being laid on ergonomics and convenience. Back then, Microsoft's Intellimouse Eye was the first mouse with Optical technology, which guarantees comfort and convenience of use.

The Acer Airkey was based on IR technology for wireless operation but Bluetooth and RF devices are no longer hampered by the line-of-sight syndrome.

